

Word family: **rule / rules / ruled / ruling / ruler / rule-based / overrule / overruling / unruly**

Base word: rule

Part of speech: mainly **noun** and **verb**

Related forms:

rule (n.) — 規則；規定；法則；準則；統治；尺規

rule (v.) — 統治；裁定；判決；支配；劃線

ruling (n./adj.) — 裁決；判決；統治的；主導的

ruler (n.) — 統治者；尺

rule-based (adj.) — 以規則為基礎的

overrule (v.) — 駁回；推翻較低層決定

unruly (adj.) — 難以控制的；不守規矩的

rule of law — 法治

rule of thumb — 經驗法則

ground rule — 基本規則

golden rule — 黃金法則；最重要原則

house rules — 場所規則 / 內部規則

business rule — 業務規則

grammar rule — 文法規則

legal rule — 法律規則

safety rule — 安全規則

exception to the rule — 規則的例外

as a rule — 通常；一般而言

rule out — 排除；不考慮；否定可能性

rule on — 就.....作出裁決

rule in favour of/against — 判某方勝訴 / 敗訴

rule with an iron fist/hand — 鐵腕統治

Major useful extensions:

present rule, strict rule, general rule, basic rule, clear rule, written rule, unwritten rule, formal rule, internal rule, company rule, school rule, safety rule, legal rule, tax rule, accounting rule, business rule, policy rule, eligibility rule, return rule, follow/obey a rule, break/violate a rule, enforce a rule, apply a rule, interpret a rule, change/revise a rule, introduce a rule, relax/tighten a rule, bend the rules, play by the rules, against the rules, within the rules, under the rules, exception to the rule, rule applies to, rule covers, rule requires, rule prohibits, rule allows, rule of thumb, ground rules, house rules, golden rule, rule of law, rule by law, majority rule, minority rule, rule over a country, rule a kingdom, rule on a case, court ruling, ruling party/class, ruler, ruler measurement, rule a line, ruled paper, rule out a possibility, rule out illness, rule someone/something out, overrule a decision, overrule an objection, unruly child/crowd.

Meaning in this passage

> At issue is not whether customers should be allowed to change their minds without limit, but whether our **present rule** is proportionate for online fashion.

Here, **rule** means:

an official requirement or restriction that controls what people are allowed or not allowed to do — 規則；規定

The specific rule is:

> **no exchange / no refund**

So the writer is asking whether that existing restriction is:

- * fair,
- * proportionate,
- * suitable for online shopping,
- * too rigid.

中文翻譯：

目前真正需要討論的，不是顧客是否應被容許毫無限制地改變主意，而是我們現行的**規定 / 規則**對網上時裝購物而言是否合乎比例。

So here:

present rule = 現行規定；目前正在實施的規則

A. RULE = OFFICIAL REQUIREMENT / REGULATION

1. **rule** = instruction controlling what is allowed or required — 規則；規定

This is the exact passage branch.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Is our **present rule** proportionate for online fashion?

我們現行的**規定**對網上時裝購物而言是否合乎比例？

Practice 2

> The company introduced a new rule on returns.

公司推出了一項新的**退貨規則**。

Practice 3

> Staff must understand the rule before applying it.

員工在執行之前必須先理解這項**規定**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****rule = 用來控制、要求或限制行為的正式規定****

2. ****present/current rule — 現行規定****

Practice 1

> The ****present rule**** does not allow cash refunds.

****現行規定****不容許現金退款。

Practice 2

> Management is reviewing the current rule.

管理層正在檢討****現行規則****。

3. ****strict rule — 嚴格規定****

Practice 1

> The store has a ****strict rule**** against returning worn items.

商店有一項****嚴格規定****，禁止退回穿過的商品。

Practice 2

> Strict rules can reduce abuse but may frustrate genuine customers.

****嚴格規則****可以減少濫用，但也可能令真正顧客感到不滿。

4. ****clear rule — 清晰規則****

Practice 1

> Every return should be governed by a **clear rule**.

每宗退貨都應有**清晰規則**管理。

Practice 2

> Clear rules reduce arguments.

清楚規定可以減少爭拗。

5. **written rule — 明文規定**

Practice 1

> The condition should be stated as a **written rule**.

這項條件應列為**明文規定**。

Practice 2

> Written rules are easier to apply consistently.

書面規則較容易一致執行。

6. **unwritten rule — 不成文規定；潛規則**

A major figurative/social use.

Practice 1

> There is an **unwritten rule** that senior staff speak first.

有一條**不成文規定**，資深員工先發言。

Practice 2

> Every workplace has some unwritten rules.

每個工作場所都有一些**不成文規矩**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****unwritten rule = 沒有正式寫下來，但大家普遍遵守的行為規範****

B. FOLLOW / OBEY / BREAK RULES

7. ****follow a rule — 遵守規則****

Practice 1

> Employees must ****follow the return rules****.

員工必須****遵守退貨規則****。

Practice 2

> The customer followed all the rules.

顧客****遵守了所有規定****。

8. ****obey a rule — 遵守規定****

Practice 1

> Everyone is expected to ****obey the rules****.

所有人都應****遵守規則****。

Practice 2

> Rules are effective only if people obey them.

只有大家願意****遵守規定****，規則才有效。

9. ****break a rule — 違反規則****

Practice 1

> The customer did not ****break any rule****.

顧客沒有**違反任何規定**。

Practice 2

> Repeatedly breaking the rules may lead to penalties.

反覆**違規**可能導致處罰。

MCQ-ready definition:

break a rule = 做了規則明確不容許的事情

10. **violate a rule — 違反規定**

More formal than **break**.

Practice 1

> The seller was accused of **violating consumer rules**.

賣家被指**違反消費者規定**。

Practice 2

> Serious violations may lead to disciplinary action.

嚴重**違規**可能導致紀律處分。

11. **against the rules — 違規；不合規定**

Practice 1

> Returning worn clothing is **against the rules**.

退回穿過的衣物**違反規定**。

Practice 2

> That is clearly against company rules.

那明顯**違反公司規定**。

12. **within the rules — 在規則容許範圍內**

Practice 1

> Staff have some discretion **within the rules**.

員工可以在**規則容許範圍內**酌情處理。

Practice 2

> The customer acted within the rules.

顧客的行為**符合規定**。

13. **under the rules — 根據規則**

Practice 1

> **Under the rules**, the item qualifies for exchange.

根據規則，該商品符合換貨資格。

Practice 2

> Refunds are allowed under the current rules.

按照**現行規定**，退款是獲准的。

C. ENFORCE / APPLY / INTERPRET RULES

14. **enforce a rule — 執行規則**

Practice 1

> Managers must **enforce the rules consistently**.

管理人員必須一致地**執行規則**。

Practice 2

> A rule that is never enforced becomes meaningless.

從不被**執行的規則**會失去意義。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****enforce a rule = 確保大家遵守規則，必要時採取處理措施****

15. ****apply a rule — 套用 / 執行規則****

Practice 1

> The rule should be ****applied fairly****.

這項規則應該****公平執行****。

Practice 2

> Staff need guidance on how to apply the rule.

員工需要指引，知道如何****套用這項規則****。

16. ****interpret a rule — 解釋規則****

Practice 1

> Different staff members may ****interpret the rule differently****.

不同員工可能對規則有不同****解讀****。

Practice 2

> The policy should reduce room for inconsistent interpretation.

政策應減少對規則****不一致解讀****的空間。

17. ****rule applies to someone/something — 規則適用於****

Practice 1

> The rule ****applies to all final-sale items****.

這項規則**適用於所有清貨商品**。

Practice 2

> Does the same rule apply to online purchases?

同一規則是否**適用於網上購物**？

18. **rule covers X — 規則涵蓋 X**

Practice 1

> The rule **covers defective goods**.

規則**涵蓋有缺陷的商品**。

Practice 2

> The policy does not clearly cover international returns.

政策沒有清楚**涵蓋國際退貨**。

19. **rule requires X — 規則要求 X**

Practice 1

> The rule **requires customers to keep the receipt**.

規則**要求顧客保留收據**。

Practice 2

> The rules require staff to inspect the item.

規定**要求員工檢查商品**。

20. **rule prohibits X — 規則禁止 X**

Practice 1

> The rule ****prohibits returns after thirty days****.

規則****禁止三十天後退貨****。

Practice 2

> Company rules prohibit unauthorised refunds.

公司規定****禁止未經授權的退款****。

21. ****rule allows X — 規則容許 X****

Practice 1

> The revised rule ****allows one exchange****.

修訂規則****容許換貨一次****。

Practice 2

> The rules allow store credit in some cases.

規定在某些情況下****容許發放購物額****。

D. CHANGE / REVISE / INTRODUCE RULES

22. ****change a rule — 更改規則****

Practice 1

> Chris wants management to ****change the current rule****.

Chris 希望管理層****更改現行規則****。

Practice 2

> Rules should be changed when they create avoidable harm.

如果規則造成可避免的損害，就應該****修改****。

23. **revise a rule — 修訂規則**

Practice 1

> The company plans to **revise the rule**.

公司計劃**修訂規則**。

Practice 2

> The return rules were revised after the pilot.

退貨規則在試行期後被**修訂**。

24. **introduce a rule — 推出 / 引入規則**

Practice 1

> Management introduced a rule requiring photographic evidence.

管理層**引入一項規定**，要求提供照片證據。

Practice 2

> New rules were introduced to prevent abuse.

公司**推出新規則**以防止濫用。

25. **relax a rule — 放寬規則**

Practice 1

> The proposal would **relax the current rule**.

方案會**放寬現行規定**。

Practice 2

> Management may relax the rule for defective goods.

管理層可能就有缺陷商品**放寬規定**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****relax a rule = 令原本嚴格的規則變得較寬鬆****

26. ****tighten a rule — 收緊規則****

Practice 1

> The company tightened the rules after detecting abuse.

公司發現濫用後****收緊規則****。

Practice 2

> Rules can be tightened without banning all returns.

可以****收緊規定****，而不必全面禁止退貨。

E. EXCEPTION TO THE RULE

27. ****exception to the rule — 規則的例外****

A major fixed expression.

Practice 1

> Defective goods should be an ****exception to the rule****.

有缺陷商品應該是這項規則的****例外****。

Practice 2

> Every rule may need carefully defined exceptions.

每項規則都可能需要有清楚界定的****例外情況****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****exception to the rule = 某種情況不按一般規則處理****

28. ****make an exception — 破例****

Practice 1

> The manager decided to **make an exception**.

經理決定**破例處理**。

Practice 2

> Exceptions should not depend entirely on personal favour.

例外處理不應完全取決於個人偏袒。

Important distinction 1: **rule vs exception**

rule

normal/default requirement.

exception

case treated differently.

In policy design:

> rule + clearly defined exceptions

is often better than:

> arbitrary discretion.

F. BEND THE RULES

29. **bend the rules** — 通融；稍微變通規則

A major idiom.

Practice 1

> Staff should not have to **bend the rules** secretly to help genuine customers.

員工不應為了幫助真正顧客而私下**通融規則**。

Practice 2

> The manager bent the rules for an exceptional case.

經理為特殊個案**稍微變通了規定**。

MCQ-ready definition:

bend the rules = 不完全按照規則最嚴格的方式處理，但又未必公然違規

30. **break the rules vs bend the rules**

break

clearly violate.

bend

stretch/interpret them flexibly.

> break the rules = 違規

> bend the rules = 通融 / 變通

Bend can still be questionable, but it is less direct than breaking.

G. PLAY BY THE RULES

31. **play by the rules — 按規矩辦事**

A major figurative idiom.

Practice 1

> Genuine customers who **play by the rules** should be treated fairly.

按規矩辦事的顧客應得到公平待遇。

Practice 2

> Everyone should play by the same rules.

所有人都應該**遵守同一套規則**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****play by the rules = 按既定規則和公平程序行事****

32. ****the same rules apply to everyone — 一視同仁****

Practice 1

> The same rules should apply to everyone.

同一套規則應****一視同仁地適用於所有人****。

Practice 2

> Transparency requires staff to know when different rules legitimately apply.

透明制度也要求員工清楚知道甚麼情況下可以合理使用不同規則。

H. GROUND RULES

33. ****ground rules — 基本規則；基本守則****

A major fixed expression.

Practice 1

> The team agreed on ****ground rules for discussion****.

團隊就討論方式定下****基本規則****。

Practice 2

> Ground rules can prevent meetings from becoming personal.

****基本守則****可以防止會議變成人身攻擊。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****ground rules = 一開始便訂立、用來控制某活動如何進行的基本規範****

34. ****set ground rules — 訂立基本規則****

Practice 1

> Managers should **set clear ground rules** before the pilot.

管理層應在試行前**訂立清晰基本規則**。

Practice 2

> Ground rules help everyone understand expectations.

基本規則讓所有人了解預期。

I. HOUSE RULES

35. **house rules** — 場所 / 機構自己的內部規則

Practice 1

> Customers must follow the store's **house rules**.

顧客必須遵守商店的**內部規則**。

Practice 2

> Every venue has its own house rules.

每個場地都有自己的**場所規則**。

MCQ-ready definition:

house rules = 某間場所、組織、家庭或遊戲局自己制定的內部規定

J. GOLDEN RULE

36. **golden rule** — 黃金法則；最重要原則

A major expression.

Practice 1

> The **golden rule** is to state return conditions clearly before payment.

最重要的**黃金法則**是在付款前清楚說明退貨條件。

Practice 2

> One golden rule of customer service is to listen before responding.

客戶服務的一條**重要原則**是先聆聽再回應。

MCQ-ready definition:

golden rule = 某領域中被視為特別重要、值得始終遵守的基本原則

K. RULE OF THUMB

37. **rule of thumb — 經驗法則；概略原則**

A very important fixed expression.

Practice 1

> As a **rule of thumb**, clearer product information reduces avoidable returns.

作為一項**經驗法則**，產品資訊愈清晰，可避免的退貨通常愈少。

Practice 2

> A rule of thumb is useful, but it is not an exact law.

經驗法則很有用，但並不是精確定律。

MCQ-ready definition:

rule of thumb = 根據實際經驗形成、方便使用但不一定精確的簡單原則

Important distinction 2: **rule vs rule of thumb**

rule

may be mandatory.

rule of thumb

practical guidance, not binding.

> return rule = 必須遵守

> rule of thumb = 經驗參考

L. AS A RULE

38. **as a rule** = generally; usually — 通常；一般而言

A completely different idiomatic use.

Practice 1

> **As a rule**, damaged goods are inspected before refunds are issued.

一般而言，有損壞的商品會在退款前接受檢查。

Practice 2

> As a rule, customers prefer clear policies.

通常來說，顧客較喜歡清晰政策。

MCQ-ready definition:

as a rule = 一般情況下；通常

This does not refer to one actual written rule.

39. **as a general rule** — 一般來說

Practice 1

> **As a general rule**, final-sale goods are non-returnable.

一般來說，清貨商品不可退貨。

Practice 2

> As a general rule, evidence should be checked before a claim is approved.

一般而言，批准申索前應先檢查證據。

M. RULE = PRINCIPLE / REGULARITY

40. **rule** = principle describing how something normally works — 法則；規律

A major non-policy sense.

Practice 1

> There are exceptions to almost every linguistic **rule**.

幾乎每條語言**規則 / 法則**都有例外。

Practice 2

> The rule describes a regular pattern.

這條**規律**描述一種固定模式。

MCQ-ready definition:

rule = 描述某個系統一般如何運作的原則或規律

41. **grammar rule** — 文法規則

Practice 1

> Learners often memorize **grammar rules**.

學習者經常背誦**文法規則**。

Practice 2

> Some grammar rules have exceptions.

部分**文法規則**有例外。

42. **spelling rule** — 拼字規則

Practice 1

> This spelling rule applies to many verbs.

這條**拼字規則**適用於很多動詞。

Practice 2

> English spelling rules are not perfectly regular.

英語**拼字規則**並非完全一致。

43. **mathematical rule — 數學規則**

Practice 1

> Apply the rule to each number.

把這條**數學規則**套用到每個數字。

Practice 2

> The sequence follows a simple rule.

這個數列遵循一條簡單的**規律**。

44. **scientific rule/law — 科學規律**

Practice 1

> The observed pattern can be expressed as a simple rule.

觀察到的模式可以用一條簡單**規律**表達。

Practice 2

> In science, “law,” “principle,” and “rule” are not always interchangeable.

科學語境中的 **law / principle / rule** 並不總是可以互換。

N. BUSINESS RULE

45. **business rule = formal logic/constraint used by a business or system — 業務規則**

A major modern enterprise/software sense.

Practice 1

> The refund system follows several **business rules**.

退款系統遵循多項**業務規則**。

Practice 2

> One business rule may state that worn items cannot be refunded.

其中一項**業務規則**可能規定穿過的商品不得退款。

MCQ-ready definition:

business rule = 組織用來控制流程、資格、計算或決策邏輯的明確規則

46. **rule-based system — 規則式系統**

Practice 1

> The company uses a **rule-based system** to flag unusual returns.

公司使用**規則式系統**標記異常退貨。

Practice 2

> A rule-based system follows predefined conditions.

以規則為基礎的系統會按照預先定義的條件運作。

47. **rule engine — 規則引擎**

A common enterprise/software term.

Practice 1

> The platform uses a **rule engine** to evaluate refund eligibility.

平台利用**規則引擎**判斷退款資格。

Practice 2

> Business rules can be updated without changing the whole application.

****業務規則****可以獨立更新，而不必重寫整個應用程式。

O. RULE OF LAW

48. ****rule of law — 法治****

A major legal/governance expression.

Practice 1

> The ****rule of law**** requires public authorities to act according to law.

****法治****要求公共機構依法行事。

Practice 2

> Rule of law is different from simply having many rules.

****法治****並不等於「有很多規則」。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****rule of law = 法律對政府和人民都有約束力，權力須依法行使的原則****

Important distinction 3: ****rule of law vs rule by law****

****rule of law****

law constrains power.

****rule by law****

law is used as an instrument through which authorities govern.

They are not automatically equivalent.

P. MAJORITY RULE

49. ****majority rule — 多數決原則****

Practice 1

> The committee operates by **majority rule**.

委員會按照**多數決原則**運作。

Practice 2

> Majority rule does not necessarily mean minority interests are irrelevant.

多數決並不代表少數人的利益可以完全忽略。

MCQ-ready definition:

majority rule = 以獲得多數支持的一方決定結果的原則

50. **minority rule — 少數統治**

Practice 1

> The phrase **minority rule** describes control by a numerical minority.

少數統治指少數人口掌握統治權。

Practice 2

> “Rule” here means governance, not a behavioural instruction.

這裡的 **rule** 是「**統治**」，不是「規則」。

Q. RULE = GOVERNMENT / CONTROL AS A NOUN

51. **rule = control/government by a ruler or regime — 統治**

A completely different noun branch.

Practice 1

> The country remained under foreign **rule** for decades.

該國數十年處於外國**統治**之下。

Practice 2

> His rule lasted twenty years.

他的**統治**持續了二十年。

MCQ-ready definition:

rule = 某人 / 政權控制並治理國家或地區的狀態或時期

52. **under someone's rule — 在某人統治下**

Practice 1

> The region changed greatly **under his rule**.

該地區在他的**統治下**發生很大變化。

Practice 2

> Taxes increased under the new ruler's rule.

在新統治者**執政期間**，稅項增加。

53. **foreign rule — 外國統治**

Practice 1

> The region resisted **foreign rule**.

該地區反抗**外國統治**。

Practice 2

> The history covers a period of colonial rule.

這段歷史涵蓋一段**殖民統治**時期。

R. RULE AS A VERB = GOVERN

54. **rule a country/kingdom — 統治國家 / 王國**

Practice 1

> The dynasty **ruled the country** for centuries.

該王朝**統治這個國家**數百年。

Practice 2

> She ruled the kingdom effectively.

她有效地**治理王國**。

MCQ-ready definition:

rule X = 作為最高統治者控制並治理 X

55. **rule over people/territory — 統治.....**

Practice 1

> The king **ruled over a large territory**.

國王**統治一大片領土**。

Practice 2

> The regime ruled over millions of people.

政權**統治數百萬人**。

56. **ruling class — 統治階級**

Practice 1

> The term **ruling class** refers to a social group with dominant political/economic power.

統治階級指掌握主要政治 / 經濟權力的社會群體。

Practice 2

> The ruling class controlled much of the land.

統治階級控制大量土地。

57. **ruling party** — 執政黨

Practice 1

> The **ruling party** introduced the proposal.

執政黨提出方案。

Practice 2

> “Ruling party” means the party currently exercising government power.

ruling party 指目前掌握政府權力的**執政黨**。

S. RULER = PERSON WHO RULES

58. **ruler** = person who governs — 統治者

Practice 1

> The ruler introduced new laws.

統治者推出新法律。

Practice 2

> Historical rulers often relied on advisers.

歷史上的**統治者**往往依靠顧問。

MCQ-ready definition:

ruler = 擁有最高統治權的人，例如君主或其他統治者

T. RULE = COURT/JUDGE DECIDES

59. **rule** = make an official judicial decision — 裁定；判決

A major legal verb branch.

Practice 1

> The court **ruled** that the policy was unlawful.

法院**裁定**該政策違法。

Practice 2

> The judge ruled against the company.

法官**判**公司一方敗訴。

MCQ-ready definition:

rule = 法官 / 法院正式就法律問題作出決定

60. **rule that... — 裁定.....**

Practice 1

> The court **ruled** that the claim was valid.

法院**裁定**申索有效。

Practice 2

> The judge ruled that the evidence was admissible.

法官**裁定**證據可被接納。

61. **rule on something — 就.....作出裁決**

Practice 1

> The court will **rule on the application** tomorrow.

法院明天會**就**申請作出裁決。

Practice 2

> A regulator may rule on whether a practice complies with its rules.

監管機構可能會**裁定**某做法是否合規。

62. **rule in favour of someone** — 判某方勝訴

Practice 1

> The court **ruled in favour of the customer**.

法院**判顧客一方勝訴**。

Practice 2

> The tribunal ruled in favour of the claimant.

審裁處**裁定申索人勝訴**。

63. **rule against someone** — 判某方敗訴 / 作出不利裁定

Practice 1

> The court **ruled against the retailer**.

法院作出**不利於零售商的裁決**。

Practice 2

> The judge ruled against the application.

法官**駁回該申請**。

U. RULING = JUDICIAL DECISION

64. **ruling** = official decision by court/authority — 裁決；判決

Practice 1

> The court issued a **ruling**.

法院作出一項**裁決**。

Practice 2

> The ruling may affect other retailers.

這項**裁決**可能影響其他零售商。

MCQ-ready definition:

ruling = 法院、裁判機構或有權機構作出的正式決定

65. **court ruling — 法院裁決**

Practice 1

> The **court ruling** clarified the law.

法院裁決釐清了法律問題。

Practice 2

> The company complied with the ruling.

公司遵守該**裁決**。

66. **ruling on X — 有關 X 的裁決**

Practice 1

> The ruling on refunds changed industry practice.

有關退款的**裁決**改變了行業做法。

Practice 2

> Management reviewed the latest ruling.

管理層檢視了最新**判決**。

V. OVERRULE

67. **overrule = reverse/reject a decision made by someone with lower authority — 推翻；駁回**

A major derivative.

Practice 1

> The manager **overruled** the employee's decision.

經理**推翻**了員工的決定。

Practice 2

> A higher court may overrule a lower court on a legal point in appropriate systems.

在適用的法律制度中，上級法院可能**推翻**下級法院的法律判斷。

MCQ-ready definition:

overrule = 有較高權力的人 / 機構否決或改變較低層原本的決定

68. **overrule an objection** — 駁回反對

A major legal phrase.

Practice 1

> The judge **overruled** the objection.

法官**駁回**了反對。

Practice 2

> “Objection overruled” means the objection is rejected.

Objection overruled 表示該項反對**不獲接納**。

69. **overrule vs uphold an objection**

overrule

reject objection.

sustain/uphold

accept objection.

These are courtroom contrasts.

W. RULE OUT

70. **rule out = eliminate something as a possibility — 排除可能性**

A major phrasal verb.

Practice 1

> We should not **rule out** a limited refund system.

我們不應**排除有限退款制度的可能性**。

Practice 2

> The evidence ruled out fraud.

證據**排除了欺詐的可能性**。

MCQ-ready definition:

rule out X = 經考慮或檢查後判斷 X 不可能 / 不適用，因此不再考慮

71. **rule out a possibility — 排除可能性**

Practice 1

> Management has not **ruled out the possibility** of extending the pilot.

管理層尚未**排除延長試行期的可能性**。

Practice 2

> We cannot rule out further changes.

我們不能**排除進一步改變**。

72. **rule someone/something out — 排除某人 / 某物**

Practice 1

> The damaged tag **rules the item out for resale**.

受損吊牌令該商品**不適合再出售**。

Practice 2

> Lack of experience may rule a candidate out.

缺乏經驗可能令候選人**失去資格 / 被排除考慮**。

73. **rule out illness/disease — 排除疾病可能**

Practice 1

> Doctors ordered tests to **rule out infection**.

醫生安排檢查以**排除感染可能**。

Practice 2

> Further tests may be needed to rule out serious causes.

可能需要進一步檢查，以**排除嚴重病因**。

Important distinction 4: **rule out vs exclude**

exclude

general:

- * leave out,
- * prevent participation,
- * eliminate.

rule out

specifically:

> conclude that something is not a viable possibility.

> exclude customers from offer

> 不讓顧客參加

> rule out fraud

> 排除欺詐可能

X. RULE = DRAW A LINE

74. **rule a line — 用尺劃線**

A distinct verb sense.

Practice 1

> **Rule a line** under the heading.

在標題下面**用尺畫一條線**。

Practice 2

> The teacher asked students to rule the page into columns.

老師要求學生**用線把頁面劃成不同欄**。

MCQ-ready definition:

rule = 用尺或直線工具畫直線

75. **ruled paper — 有橫線的紙**

Practice 1

> Write your answer on **ruled paper**.

把答案寫在**橫線紙**上。

Practice 2

> The notebook contains wide-ruled pages.

筆記簿使用**寬行距橫線頁**。

Y. RULER = MEASURING TOOL

76. **ruler = straight measuring tool — 尺 ; 直尺**

A completely separate everyday noun sense.

Practice 1

> Use a **ruler** to measure the sleeve.

用**尺**量袖長。

Practice 2

> Draw a straight line with a ruler.

用**直尺**畫一條直線。

MCQ-ready definition:

ruler = 用來量度長度或畫直線的長條形工具

Important distinction 5: **ruler = person vs ruler = tool**

Person:

> the ruler of the kingdom

> 王國**統治者**

Tool:

> a 30-centimetre ruler

> 30 厘米**直尺**

Completely different noun senses.

Z. UNRULY

77. **unruly = difficult to control; not obeying rules — 難以控制的 ; 不守規矩的**

A lexicalized family extension.

Practice 1

> An **unruly crowd** caused disruption.

一群**難以控制的人群**造成混亂。

Practice 2

> The teacher struggled with an unruly class.

老師很難控制這個**不守規矩的班級**。

MCQ-ready definition:

unruly = 不容易被控制、管理或約束的

78. **unruly behaviour — 難以控制 / 不守規矩的行為**

Practice 1

> Unruly behaviour may lead to removal from the venue.

不守規矩的行為可能導致被要求離場。

Practice 2

> Clear rules can reduce unruly behaviour.

清晰規則可以減少**失控行為**。

AA. RULE WITH AN IRON FIST / HAND

79. **rule with an iron fist/hand — 鐵腕統治**

A major figurative idiom.

Practice 1

> The ruler **ruled with an iron fist**.

統治者以**鐵腕手段治理**。

Practice 2

> A manager who rules with an iron fist may discourage honest feedback.

以**鐵腕方式管理**的經理可能令員工不敢坦白提出意見。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****rule with an iron fist = 用非常嚴厲、強硬和集權的方式控制他人****

AB. RULE THE ROOST

80. ****rule the roost — 當家作主；掌權；說了算****

Informal idiom.

Practice 1

> In that department, one senior manager ****rules the roost****.

在那個部門，一名資深經理幾乎****完全說了算****。

Practice 2

> She has ruled the roost for years.

她多年來一直在那裡****掌握主導權****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****rule the roost = informal: 在某個家庭、群體或環境中掌握最大控制權****

AC. RULE = DOMINATE / BE SUPREME

81. ****X rules = X dominates / is extremely good — X 最強 / 稱霸****

Informal/slang.

Practice 1

> In informal speech, someone might say, "This band ****rules****!"

在非正式語氣中，****X rules!**** 可以表示「X ****超棒 / 最強****！」

Practice 2

> This slang use is not appropriate for formal business writing.

這種俚語用法不適合正式商業寫作。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****X rules! = informal/slang: X 非常出色、厲害****

AD. RULE IN SPORTS / GAMES

82. ****rules of a game — 遊戲 / 比賽規則****

Practice 1

> Players must know the ****rules of the game****.

參賽者必須了解****比賽規則****。

Practice 2

> The referee applies the rules.

裁判負責****執行比賽規則****。

83. ****under the rules of the competition — 按比賽規則****

Practice 1

> The action is permitted ****under the rules of the competition****.

按照****比賽規則****，這項行為是准許的。

Practice 2

> Different competitions may use different rules.

不同賽事可能使用不同****規則****。

Important distinction 6: ****rule vs regulation****

rule

broad:

- * company,
- * school,
- * game,
- * grammar,
- * law.

regulation

usually more formal, especially:

- * governmental,
- * administrative,
- * safety,
- * industry.

- > store rule
- > 商店規定

- > government regulation
- > 政府規例

A regulation is a type of formal rule.

Important distinction 7: **rule vs policy**

Central to your passage.

rule

specific requirement:

- > no refunds after fourteen days.

policy

broader set of principles/rules governing decisions:

- > returns policy.

So:

- > policy = larger framework
- > rule = specific instruction inside it.

Your passage says:

- > no-exchange/no-refund **policy**

and later:

- > present **rule**

because the writer can refer either to:

- * the whole policy,
- * or the particular restrictive rule.

Important distinction 8: **rule vs guideline**

rule

expected to be followed.

guideline

recommended guidance, often allowing more flexibility.

- > rule: item must be unworn
- > guideline: photos should be clear

unless the policy makes both mandatory.

Important distinction 9: **rule vs principle**

rule

specific instruction.

principle

broader underlying belief/standard.

- > rule: refund defective items within 14 days
- > principle: treat customers fairly

Principles can generate rules.

Important distinction 10: **rule vs criterion**

criterion

standard used to judge eligibility/quality.

rule

instruction governing behaviour/decision.

Example:

- > criterion: item is unworn
- > rule: unworn items may be exchanged once

Important distinction 11: **rule vs condition**

condition

requirement that must be satisfied.

rule

broader governing statement.

- > condition: tags attached
- > rule: returns are accepted only when conditions are met

Important distinction 12: **rule vs requirement**

requirement

something mandatory.

rule

statement that may create requirements or prohibitions.

> requirement: include order number

> rule: every return request must include an order number

Important distinction 13: **rule vs law**

law

legally binding rule created/recognized by legal authority.

rule

may be:

* internal,

* social,

* grammatical,

* game-based.

Breaking a company rule is not automatically breaking the law.

Important distinction 14: **rule vs standard**

standard

expected level/benchmark.

rule

instruction.

> quality standard

> 品質標準

> inspection rule

> 檢查規則

Important distinction 15: **rule vs procedure**

rule

what is permitted/required.

procedure

how the task is carried out step by step.

In your passage:

> rule = refundable only if defective

> procedure = customer submits photos → warehouse inspects → refund issued.

Very important policy-design distinction.

Important distinction 16: **rule vs safeguard**

rule

instruction/restriction.

safeguard

measure designed to prevent harm/abuse.

Example:

> rule: only one exchange

> safeguard: tamper-evident tag

A safeguard may be implemented through a rule, but the concepts differ.

Important distinction 17: **rule vs ban**

rule

can:

* permit,

* require,

* restrict.

ban

specifically prohibits.

Your current passage describes the existing policy as:

> a **blanket ban**

which is much stronger than merely:

> a rule.

Important distinction 18: **rule vs norm**

rule

explicit or understood requirement.

norm

socially expected behaviour.

> workplace rule

> formal/informal instruction

> workplace norm

> what people generally expect/do

An unwritten rule can function like a norm.

Important distinction 19: **unwritten rule vs norm**

Very close.

unwritten rule

feels like a specific implicit expectation.

norm

broader habitual/social standard.

Important distinction 20: **rule of thumb vs formula**

rule of thumb

rough practical guidance.

formula

precise formal method/calculation.

Do not use a rule of thumb where exactness is legally or technically required.

Important distinction 21: **as a rule vs according to the rule**

as a rule

usually.

> As a rule, returns take three days.

according to the rule

because the rule says so.

> According to the rule, refunds require inspection.

Completely different.

Important distinction 22: **rule out vs prohibit**

rule out

eliminate as an option/possibility.

prohibit

forbid.

- > rule out cash refunds
- > decide they are not a viable option

- > prohibit cash refunds
- > formally forbid them

Important distinction 23: **rule out vs reject**

reject

refuse a specific proposal/request.

rule out

decide not to consider something as a possible option.

- > reject this refund request
- > 拒絕這宗申請

- > rule out refunds entirely
- > 排除退款制度這個選項

Important distinction 24: **rule as law vs rule as governance**

Compare:

- > obey the **rule**
- > 遵守**規則**

- > under foreign **rule**
- > 在外國**統治**下

Same noun, completely different meaning.

Important distinction 25: **ruling = judgment vs ruling = governing**

court ruling

法院裁決

ruling party

執政黨

Same form, two very different senses.

Important distinction 26: **ruler = sovereign vs ruler = measuring tool**

Again:

> ruler of a country

> 統治者

> ruler on a desk

> 直尺

Context completely determines meaning.

Important distinction 27: **overrule vs rule against**

rule against someone

judge decides against them.

overrule someone

higher authority reverses/rejects their decision.

Not the same.

Important distinction 28: **overrule vs override**

overrule

higher authority rejects/reverses another decision.

override

set aside/control over something, often:

- * systems,
- * settings,
- * decisions.

- > manager overruled employee
- > manual override disabled automatic rule

They overlap in authority contexts but are not identical.

Important distinction 29: **rule-based vs principle-based**

rule-based

decisions follow explicit detailed rules.

principle-based

decisions apply broader principles with more judgment.

Your proposed returns system actually combines both:

- * explicit rules,
- * limited discretion.

Important distinction 30: **rule-based vs discretionary**

rule-based

outcome determined mainly by predefined rules.

discretionary

decision-maker has room for judgment.

Your passage later says:

- > each **discretionary exchange**...

So the proposed policy is not purely rule-based.

AE. RULE IN YOUR PASSAGE

The exact sentence is:

> At issue is not whether customers should be allowed to change their minds without limit, but whether our **present rule** is proportionate for online fashion.

The **present rule** is essentially:

no exchange + no refund

The letter challenges it because online customers cannot:

- * try on clothing,
- * feel fabric,
- * compare sizes physically,
- * verify fit before purchase.

So the question is not:

> “Should there be no rules?”

It is:

“Is this particular rule too rigid for the risk customers face when buying online?”

That is an important distinction.

Chris proposes replacing:

> **one absolute rule**

with:

> **a more detailed set of conditional rules and safeguards.**

Important distinction 31: **strict rule vs fair rule**

A rule can be:

- * strict but fair,
- * strict and unfair,
- * flexible but inconsistent,
- * flexible and fair.

So:

strictness $\neq$ fairness.

Your passage argues that a blanket no-refund rule may be:

> simple and strict,

but not necessarily:

> proportionate or fair.

Important distinction 32: ****simple rule vs workable rule****

A very simple rule:

> “No returns.”

is easy to understand.

But a workable rule must also handle:

- * defects,
- * wrong deliveries,
- * misleading descriptions,
- * hygiene concerns,
- * abuse risks.

So:

simplicity $\neq$ good policy design.

Important distinction 33: ****rule vs discretion in the passage****

The current policy leaves staff:

> ****little room to resolve fair cases.****

That means the rule is so rigid that:

staff discretion $\approx$ zero.

The proposed system introduces:

> clear rules + limited discretion.

This is a much more sophisticated design.

Important distinction 34: **rule vs proportionality**

A rule can be clear and consistently enforced but still be:

> disproportionate.

For example:

> total ban for every return reason

may treat:

- * defective zip,
- * wrong colour,
- * simple change of mind

as if they were identical cases.

The letter argues they should not be treated identically.

Family-extension note

The **rule** family has several major modern branches:

1. **official requirement**

- * present rule
- * strict rule

2. **compliance**

- * follow rules
- * break rules
- * against the rules

3. ****implementation****

- * enforce
- * apply
- * interpret rules

4. ****rule design****

- * introduce
- * revise
- * relax
- * tighten

5. ****exceptions/flexibility****

- * exception to the rule
- * bend the rules

6. ****fair conduct****

- * play by the rules

7. ****basic behavioural framework****

- * ground rules
- * house rules

8. ****important principle****

- * golden rule

9. ****rough practical guidance****

- * rule of thumb

10. ****general tendency****

- * as a rule

11. ****academic/system regularity****

- * grammar rule
- * mathematical rule

12. ****enterprise/software logic****

- * business rule
- * rule-based system

13. **legal/governance principle**

- * rule of law

14. **voting/governance**

- * majority rule

15. **government/control**

- * foreign rule
- * rule a country

16. **governing person**

- * ruler

17. **judicial decision**

- * court rules
- * ruling

18. **higher-authority reversal**

- * overrule

19. **exclude a possibility**

- * rule out

20. **draw straight lines**

- * rule a line
- * ruled paper

21. **measurement**

- * ruler

22. **difficult to control**

- * unruly

23. **idiomatic domination**

* rule with an iron fist

* rule the roost

24. **informal praise**

* X rules!

For your passage, the exact branch is:

rule = a specific policy requirement that determines what customers are or are not permitted to do

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
-----	-----	-----
rule	規則；規定	passage sense
present/current rule	現行規定	existing rule
strict rule	嚴格規定	rigidity
clear rule	清晰規則	clarity
written rule	明文規定	explicit
unwritten rule	不成文規定	implicit norm
follow a rule	遵守規則	compliance
obey a rule	遵守規定	compliance
break a rule	違反規則	non-compliance
violate a rule	違規	formal
against the rules	違規	prohibition
within the rules	在規則範圍內	compliance
under the rules	根據規則	basis
enforce a rule	執行規則	enforcement
apply a rule	套用 / 執行規則	implementation
interpret a rule	解讀規則	interpretation
rule applies to X	規則適用於 X	scope
rule covers X	規則涵蓋 X	scope
rule requires X	規則要求 X	obligation
rule prohibits X	規則禁止 X	prohibition
rule allows X	規則容許 X	permission
change a rule	更改規則	revision
revise a rule	修訂規則	revision
introduce a rule	引入規則	creation
relax a rule	放寬規則	flexibility
tighten a rule	收緊規則	restriction

exception to the rule	規則例外	exception	
bend the rules	通融 / 變通規則	flexibility	
play by the rules	按規矩辦事	fair compliance	
ground rules	基本規則	activity framework	
house rules	內部 / 場所規則	local rules	
golden rule	黃金法則	key principle	
rule of thumb	經驗法則	approximation	
as a rule	一般而言	usually	
grammar rule	文法規則	language	
spelling rule	拼字規則	language	
mathematical rule	數學規則	mathematics	
business rule	業務規則	enterprise logic	
rule-based system	規則式系統	computing/business	
rule of law	法治	legal principle	
majority rule	多數決	governance	
rule (government)	統治	governance	
under X's rule	在 X 統治下	governance	
rule a country	統治國家	verb	
rule over X	統治 X	governance	
ruling party	執政黨	governance	
ruling class	統治階級	society	
ruler (person)	統治者	governance	
rule (court)	裁定；判決	law	
**rule that... **	裁定.....	law	
rule on X	就 X 作出裁決	law	
rule in favour of	判某方勝訴	law	
rule against	判某方敗訴	law	
ruling	裁決；判決	law	
court ruling	法院裁決	law	
overrule	推翻 / 駁回	authority	
overrule an objection	駁回反對	law	
rule out	排除可能性	phrasal verb	
rule out a possibility	排除可能	reasoning	
rule out illness	排除疾病	medicine	
rule a line	用尺劃線	drawing	
ruled paper	橫線紙	stationery	
ruler (tool)	尺；直尺	measurement	
unruly	難以控制的	behaviour	
unruly behaviour	不守規矩的行為	behaviour	
rule with an iron fist	鐵腕統治	authoritarian control	
rule the roost	掌權 / 說了算	idiom	
X rules!	X 超棒 / 最強	slang	

For your original sentence

> At issue is not whether customers should be allowed to change their minds without limit, but whether our **present rule** is proportionate for online fashion.

Here:

present rule = 公司目前正式採用、限制顧客不得換貨或退款的具體規定

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 真正需要討論的不是應否讓顧客毫無限制地改變主意，而是我們的**現行規定**對網上時裝購物而言是否合乎比例。

The cleanest learner contrast is:

- > **rule** = 具體規則 / 要求
- > **policy** = 較大的政策框架
- > **condition** = 必須符合的條件
- > **criterion** = 判斷資格的準則
- > **requirement** = 強制要求
- > **guideline** = 指引，不一定強制
- > **procedure** = 實際操作步驟
- > **regulation** = 較正式的規例，常見於政府 / 行業
- > **law** = 法律
- > **safeguard** = 防止濫用 / 傷害的保護措施

And the passage's policy logic can be mapped very neatly:

- > **current rule** = no exchange / no refund
- > ↓ too rigid
- > **revised policy** = conditional permission
- > ↓ implemented through
- > **specific rules** = time limit, tags, inspections, evidence
- > +
- > **safeguards** = return limits, flagged patterns, tamper-evident tags
- > +
- > **limited discretion** = fair exceptional cases

So the letter is not proposing **fewer rules**. It is proposing **better-designed rules**.